

NAVEEN REDDY ALKA

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PROFILE

Senior Software Engineer with 17+ years of progressive expertise in platform infrastructure, distributed systems, and large-scale backend engineering across FinTech, Payments, and eCommerce. At Credit Karma, architected the Portal Provider framework now powering 90%+ of all portals clients, and led the organization's most complex platform migrations end-to-end. Previously designed MakeMyTrip's payments platform from scratch — a multi-datacenter, multi-tenant system integrating 80+ payment gateways — cutting response times by 50%, maintenance costs by 60%, and generating millions in incremental revenue. Recognized for founding-level contributions at two companies and three promotions at Wavecrest within four years. Core stack: Java · Scala · TypeScript · Kafka · Cassandra · Kubernetes · Spring Boot · AWS/GCP/Azure. MS Computer Science, Arizona State University 2021.

SKILLS

Languages: Java (SCJP 98%), Scala, Kotlin, TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, Perl

Frameworks: Spring Boot, Spring WebFlux, Project Reactor, Hibernate, Finagle, Node.js, GraphQL, Jersey, Struts2

Messaging & Streaming: Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ, ActiveMQ

Databases: Cassandra, Redis, CouchBase, Elasticsearch, MySQL, PostgreSQL, Oracle, MongoDB

Cloud & Infra: AWS, GCP, Azure, Kubernetes, Docker, Nginx, HAProxy, Tomcat

Observability: Datadog, New Relic, Splunk, Sentry, Graphite/StatsD

CI/CD & Build: GitLab CI/CD, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, Maven, Gradle, Git, SVN

Practices: Microservices, Event-Driven Architecture, Event Sourcing, TDD, PCI DSS, Agile/Scrum, System Design

EXPERIENCE

Credit Karma, Oakland · Staff Software Engineer · Feb 2022 – Present

- Designed and built the Portal Provider framework — the core abstraction for dynamic portal configuration that **90%+ of Credit Karma portals clients** depend on; directly underpins the federated portals SDK architecture adopted org-wide.
- Led end-to-end architecture and delivery of the Dashboard × Portals SDK federation — the team's most complex migration — designing the Bridge API for phased A/B rollout; achieved **100% production ramp**, enabled RecSys V2 integration, and unblocked new vertical onboarding (HELOC, Home Refi); recognized with 5+ public kudos by VP and two Directors.
- Architected Portals Local Eligibility (GA Feb 2025) — moved eligibility evaluation from centralized backend into client-side SDK, delivering **45% faster rendering** and eliminating redundant upstream network calls across the Assets team.
- Led Data Contracts from inception through production (Oct 2025) — built cross-language codegen pipeline (TypeScript, GraphQL, Scala), authored Thrift IDL, and automated publish pipeline reducing contract release time **from days to minutes**; named by Director as org-wide adoption lead.
- Diagnosed and resolved critical Talon/Polly production incidents at scale: memory leaks, pm2 socket exhaustion halting request handling, MGS startup latency spikes; built reusable load testing infra now used across all Polly teams.
- Own and evolve the Finagle-based web framework (EOL Twitter stack) serving all Credit Karma product teams — managing SLAs, scalability, and incremental modernization in Scala and TypeScript.

Turo, San Francisco · Senior Software Engineer · Jan 2021 – Feb 2022

- Identified and resolved critical network, infrastructure, and design-level bottlenecks on the core platform backend — optimizing API-to-database communication patterns, reducing latency by up to **30%** and significantly improving system throughput.
- Led modernization of high-traffic legacy services, improving reliability, reducing incident rate, and raising overall platform performance across the backend.

Pearson Inc, San Francisco · Senior Software Engineer · Jan 2020 – Jan 2021

- Architected and delivered cross-cutting platform services — logging, security, metrics, and monitoring — using reactive programming (Spring WebFlux, Project Reactor) adopted by **all engineering teams**, eliminating duplicated boilerplate and

standardizing observability across the organization.

- Delivered Kafka-based event pipelines, CouchBase data layer, and Kubernetes + AWS shared infrastructure enabling Pearson's reactive architecture roadmap — reducing per-team infrastructure setup time by weeks.

Nordstrom, Seattle · Senior Engineer · Mar 2019 – Oct 2019 · \$150,000

- Part of the Ordering and Allocation team leading decommission of legacy monolithic ordering systems into cloud-native microservices using Spring Boot + REST/SOAP, deployed on Kubernetes across AWS and GCP with GitLab CI/CD.
- Drove performance optimization, security hardening, and distributed systems best practices across the team; worked with MySQL, Postgres, Docker/Linux, and full-stack distributed architecture.

Wenova Inc, St. Louis · Software Engineer · Mar 2018 – Mar 2019

- Designed and built the Customer Data Hub (CDH) — a central microservice acting as the system of record for all customer data, exposing REST and GraphQL APIs to 10+ internal systems including Salesforce, with Kafka event-driven propagation ensuring real-time consistency.
- Developed and integrated software systems on AWS using Java/Spring/Hibernate, XML/XSLT/SOAP/JSON, PostgreSQL, and NoSQL databases; delivered complex data transformation pipelines and REST web services in Agile environment.

MakeMyTrip, Bangalore · Sr. Principal Software Engineer — Payments Architect · Sep 2016 – Jan 2018

- Sole architect of MakeMyTrip's payments platform revamp — designed and delivered a ground-up, multi-datacenter, multi-tenant system integrating **80+ payment gateways and aggregators** supporting every payment instrument in India (saved cards over HSM, wallets, discounting, fraud management, admin cockpit).
- Achieved **50% reduction in average payment response time**, **60% reduction in maintenance cost**, and a **2%+ improvement in payment success rate** over billions of dollars of monthly transactions — driving **millions in incremental revenue**.
- Built and led a team of 5 engineers; owned full delivery lifecycle including architecture walkthroughs with CTO and Chief Architect, POC development, A/B testing, staged production rollout, disaster recovery, and complete CI/CD automation via Jenkins + Cucumber + Selenium.
- Stack: Java · Spring · Hibernate · MySQL · CouchBase · RabbitMQ · Kafka · Cassandra · Tomcat · Jenkins.

VERSE – DailyHunt, Bangalore · Principal Software Engineer · Apr 2016 – Sep 2016

- Designed and built a dynamic Books search platform serving millions of search queries — full-text search, fuzzy matching, autocomplete, and vernacular language support — using Elasticsearch + Node.js at scale.
- Stack: Java · Spring · Hibernate · Elasticsearch · Node.js · Kafka · Redis · Docker.

Myntra – Flipkart, Bangalore · Technical Lead, Secure Checkout · Dec 2013 – Mar 2016

- Led the Secure Checkout team owning Payments, Address, and Cart systems on India's largest fashion eCommerce platform — maintained **100% uptime at 500M+ active carts and 150,000+ daily payment transactions** during peak sale events.
- Designed and built Payment Plan Service (PPS) from scratch — unified ownership of all multi-instrument payment transactions (CC, DC, Gift Cards, Wallets, CashBack) with an auto-switching algorithm dynamically selecting the optimal gateway per transaction.
- Engineered 50x traffic scaling for End of Season Sale — built Cassandra-based NoSQL primary store and a first-of-its-kind application-level distributed sharding solution over MySQL to manage 500M+ cart objects on a relational database.
- Stack: Java · Spring · Hibernate · MySQL · Cassandra · Jersey · Nginx · ZooKeeper · ActiveMQ · Elasticsearch · HAProxy · Jenkins · Tomcat.

Wavecrest Payment Services, Hyderabad · Dev Lead (SE → SSE → Lead Eng → Dev Lead) · Nov 2009 – Dec 2013

- Founding member of the Wavecrest engineering team — promoted **three times in four years** (Software Engineer → Senior → Lead Engineer → Dev Lead) based on exceptional performance and technical leadership.
- Led a team of 8 engineers building cashier and eWallet products: prepaid gift cards, payroll cards, tax refund cards, open/closed loop solutions, digital wallets, and mobile payments — processing **200,000+ new card issuances per day** with full PCI compliance.
- Delivered enterprise financial systems for PartyGaming-Bwin, Reliance, GTECH, TrillionPay, O2, Loopium, and Tarcha; accountable for architecture, code quality, performance reviews, and mentorship of the full team.

- Stack: Java · Spring · Hibernate · MySQL · RMI/EJB · ActiveMQ · SOAP · REST · Redis · Docker · Dojo/jQuery · Jenkins.

IvyComptech, Hyderabad · Software Engineer · Jan 2009 – Nov 2009

- Built new scalable components for Store, Affiliates, and Loyalty Systems — delivered features and performance improvements across a high-traffic gaming affiliate platform.
- Stack: Java · Spring · Struts2 · Perl · MySQL · Ajax · Jenkins · Tomcat.

Cognizant, Hyderabad · Program Analyst · Nov 2007 – Jan 2009

- Core engineer on the American Express small business credit card apply site — led the Apply-Strategy project delivering a complete upgrade to the data management system, including data migration, Struts front-end controllers, and DOJO JavaScript framework migration from MooTools.
- Stack: Java · J2EE · Struts · XSLT · XSD · Dojo · EJB · RMI · Tomcat.

EDUCATION

Arizona State University — MS Computer Science, 2021

National Institute of Technology, Warangal — B.Tech Civil Engineering, 2007